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SECURITY



**Tea app disables DMs
after second data breach
exposed over a million
private messages**

Last week, the dating safety app Tea experienced a [data breach](#), exposing 72,000 sensitive images containing selfies and photo IDs for account verification, as well as images from posts and messages. The personal data was reportedly shared by users on 4chan.

As now reported by [404 Media](#), a second security issue exposed more user data, prompting the app to disable its direct messaging feature on Tuesday afternoon.

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IMAGE CREDITS: ARTEM PODREZ

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Earlier this week, 404 Media received a tip from independent security researcher Kasra Rahjerdi, including messages between users sharing phone numbers and discussing abortions and unfaithful partners.

The app — created to provide a platform for women to exchange information about men they've dated — released a [statement](#) last week regarding the initial breach, stating that it only affected users who signed up before February 2024. Rahjerdi's findings revealed messages from early 2023 until up to last week, with more than 1.1 million messages recorded.

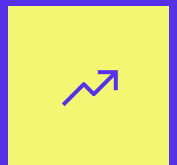
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Seemingly in response to the report, Tea [announced](#) on Instagram that it has temporarily disabled its direct messaging feature. The company stated that “Out of an abundance of caution, we have taken the affected system offline,” likely as a precaution following the second security incident.

Tea, which launched in 2023 but has since gained wide attention, currently ranks No. 2 on the Apple App Store’s top free app chart. According to estimates from Sensor Tower, the app has around 2 million monthly active users as of this month.

This story was updated to include the app’s announcement on Instagram and Sensor Tower estimates.

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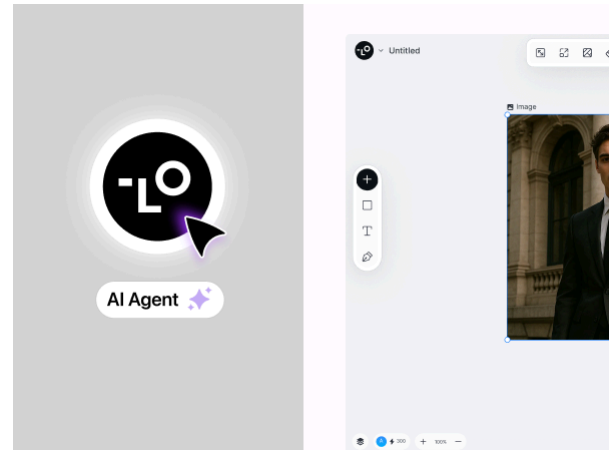
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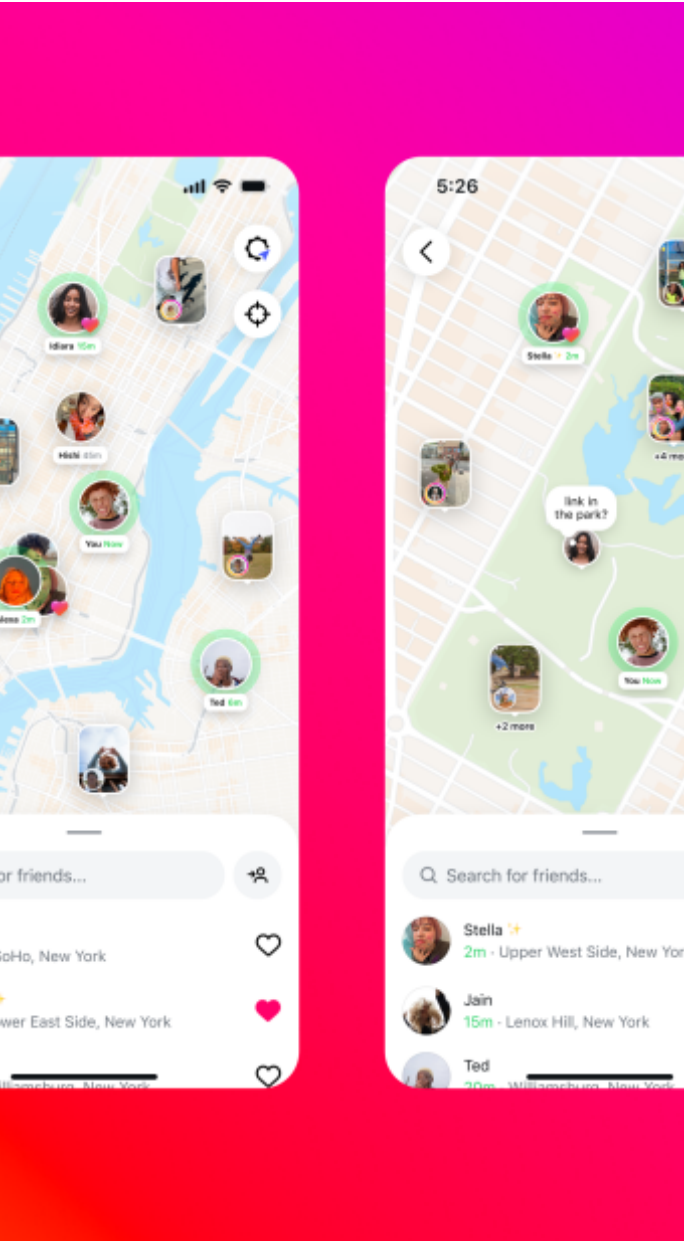
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APPS

Instagram takes on Snapchat with new ‘Instagram Map’

Aisha Malik — 7:00 AM PDT · August 6, 2025

Instagram is rolling out Instagram Map, a new feature that lets users share their most recent active location with others and discover location-based content. The Meta-owned social network is also launching reposts, and making its “Friends” tab in Reels available globally.

With its new map feature, Instagram is copying yet another popular feature from Snapchat, after cloning the app’s core Stories functionality [back in 2016](#). Instagram is coming for Snap Map’s crown, a feature that recently surpassed 400 million monthly active users and remains one of the app’s core offerings.

Instagram notes that location sharing is off by default on Instagram Map, and a user’s location only updates when they open the app, meaning it doesn’t provide real-time location updates. Snap Map, on the other hand, allows users to choose whether their location is updated only when they open the app or in real time.

It’s worth noting that Instagram does offer [real-time location sharing via DMs](#) (direct messages).

However, unlike Apple’s Find My and Snap Map, which let you share your location with others indefinitely, Instagram only lets users do so for up to one hour.

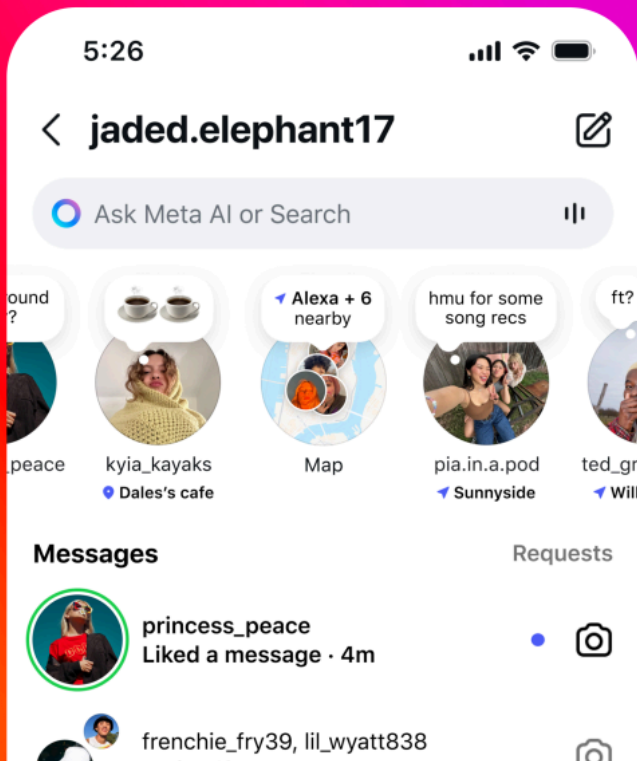


IMAGE CREDITS: INSTAGRAM

Instagram says the new map feature will make it easier for friends to coordinate and link up for hangouts. It also lets users explore location-based content that their friends and favorite creators have shared or engaged with. For example, if your friend attends a nearby music festival and posts a story while there, it will appear on the map. Similarly, if a creator posts a reel about a new restaurant in your city, you'll be able to discover it on Instagram Map.

Regardless of whether you choose to share your location, you can use the map to explore location-based content, Instagram says.

The map also allows users to leave short messages, or "[Notes,](#)" on the map for others to see. Instagram Notes are currently the short messages that appear at the top of your direct messaging feed, but with the launch of Instagram Map, users can now post these short updates on the map.

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Although Instagram is certainly taking on Snapchat with this new feature, it also has the opportunity to appeal to people who were fans of [Zenly](#), a social map app that Snap acquired and then shut down in 2023.

The new map feature is launching in the United States starting Wednesday, with broader global availability coming soon. Users can find the Instagram Map at the top of their DM inbox.

The launch doesn't come as a surprise, as [Instagram was spotted developing](#) the map feature last year.



As for the new “Reposts” feature, Instagram is taking a page out of [TikTok’s book](#) while also creating its own version of the popular “retweet” function from Twitter (now X).

This feature lets Instagram users repost public reels and feed posts. These reposts may show up in their friends’ feeds and will also be displayed in a new “Reposts” tab on their profile. Instagram says the new feature gives users a way to share their interests with others and also offers creators the opportunity to reach a wider audience.

To repost a reel or post, users tap the repost icon. Users can also choose to add a note to the repost by typing into the thought bubble that appears on screen and pressing save.

Regarding the new “Friends” tab in Reels, Instagram launched it in the United States earlier this year and is now making it available globally. The tab lets you see public reels that your friends have liked, commented on, reposted, and created.

For users who want to browse and interact with content privately, Instagram is rolling out the ability to opt out of having content you’ve engaged with shown in the friends tab.

Users can hide their likes, comments, and reposts from the tab. Additionally, they can choose to mute likes, comments, and reposts from specific people they follow.

Topics: [Apps](#) [Instagram](#) [instagram map](#) [Snap Map](#)

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Aisha Malik

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Aisha is a consumer news reporter at TechCrunch. Prior to joining the publication in 2021, she was a telecom reporte...

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TeaOnHer, a rival Tea app for men, is leaking users' personal data and driver's licenses

Amanda Silberling, Zack Whittaker

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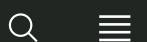
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The app, which launched on the Apple App Store earlier this week, is a response to another viral app Tea that allows women to post about the men they date. Tea is advertised as a women's safety app with more than 6 million users that is similar to "[Are we dating the same guy?](#)" Facebook networks. However, the app is controversial, since many of the claims that women post cannot be verified.

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The backlash surrounding Tea escalated last week, after 404 Media reported 4chan users retaliated by [discovering a publicly exposed database](#) belonging to the app, which [revealed](#) over 72,000 images, including thousands of selfies and photo IDs submitted for account verification. A [subsequent hack](#) exposed more than 1 million private messages sent over the app, prompting the app to [disable](#) its messaging feature.

TeaOnHer, which is now ranked No. 2 among Lifestyle apps on iOS, appears to be a direct rebuttal to the Tea app, even copying the language from Tea's App Store description in its own listing.

But like the app it sought to emulate, TeaOnHer contains security flaws of its own.

TechCrunch has found at least one security flaw that allows anyone access to data belonging to TeaOnHer app users, including their usernames and associated email addresses, as well as driver's licenses and selfies that users uploaded to TeaOnHer. Images of these driver's licenses are publicly accessible web addresses, allowing

Zack Whittaker - 14 hours ago

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TeaOnHer, a rival Tea app for men, is leaking users' personal data and driver's licenses

Amanda Silberling,
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anyone with the links to access them using their web browser.

In one case, TechCrunch saw a list of posts shared on TeaOnHer appended with each user's email address, display name, and self-reported location.

TechCrunch is withholding some of the details of the bugs so as to not help malicious actors access anyone's data. The app's maker did not respond to emails from TechCrunch asking who we can report the flaws to. As such, TechCrunch is publishing this report with limited details of the issue, given the app's current popularity and the risk faced with using the app.

TeaOnHer was uploaded to the iOS App Store by a developer named Newville Media Corporation. According to LinkedIn, the founder and CEO of this company is Xavier Lampkin.

TechCrunch identified at least one TeaOnHer record associated with Lampkin's own data.

The security lapse will likely affect any user who signed up or shared identity documents with the app. The bug also exposes the number of users the TeaOnHer app has, which is about 53,000 users at the time of publication.

TechCrunch also identified a potential second security issue, in which an email address and plaintext password belonging to the app's creator, Lampkin, was left exposed on the server. The credentials appear to grant access to the app's "admin" panel. TechCrunch did not use the credentials, as doing so would be unlawful, but highlights the risks of inadvertently leaving admin credentials exposed to the web.

Along with its security flaws, the content portrayed within TeaOnHer is troubling in itself. While the app

requests IDs and selfies from its users to verify their identities — a process that is not automatic — users can access a “guest” view of the app without signing in.

Immediately upon opening “guest” view, TechCrunch saw several images of the same naked woman, posted under different names in a form of spam. It is not clear if this woman consented to this photo being shared. Other posts share the photos and names of women, alongside comments calling them “easy,” or accusing them of spreading sexually transmitted infections.

Across all free apps, TeaOnHer is ranked No. 17, higher than apps like Instagram, Netflix, Uber, and Spotify. Tea is currently ranked No. 2.

Topics: [apple app store](#) [cybersecurity](#) [data protection](#)

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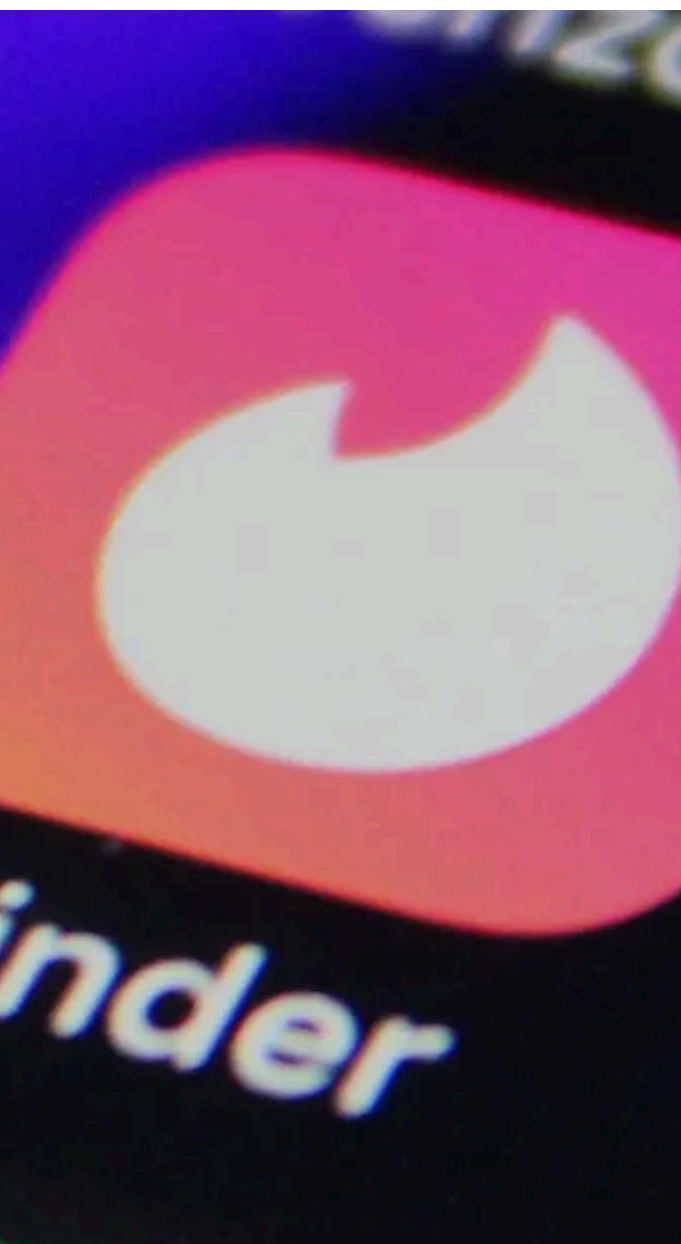


IMAGE CREDITS: TECHCRUNCH

APPS



Tinder explores a redesign, dating ‘modes,’ and college-specific features to boost engagement

Ivan Mehta — 6:40 AM PDT · August 6, 2025

Tinder is still struggling to generate revenue from its users, as it reported a 7% dip in paying users while its parent company, Match Group, saw a 5% dip in Q2 2025 across all dating apps, including Tinder, Hinge, Match.com, and others.

To boost engagement and push more people to pay for its product, the company has undertaken multiple new initiatives. During Match’s second-

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quarter earnings call, Match Group CEO Spencer Rascoff said that Tinder will debut a new feature called “modes,” which will allow users to switch between different dating goals to explore new connections in real time. This is similar to a previous option where Tinder allowed users to put their [relationship goals directly on their profiles](#).

Tinder will also explore a broader redesign and other new features, including those aimed at college students, to drive more usage among Gen Z.

Another new feature allows users to like specific parts of a profile, nudging people to start conversations based on those likes, similar to Match’s dating app Hinge.

The changes arrive amid a mixed quarter for the dating app giant, which [reported](#) flat year-over-year revenue of \$864 million and earnings that declined from \$133.3 million year-over-year to \$122.5 million in Q2. However, the company provided a better-than-expected Q3 outlook with revenue reaching \$910-920 million, which boosted its stock post-earnings.

Match also announced it would invest \$50 million in product development, as the dating app maker aims to connect with younger Gen Z users and use AI to improve its products.

“We’ll take the first steps towards a new UI refresh in Q3 with a cleaner, faster, and more modern look across the entire app,” Rascoff said. “We’re on track to test version one of a redesigned ‘see who likes you’ tab this fall with the goal of helping users connect with people they’re more likely to be interested in, as well as to drive more revenue,” he added.

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In the case of the latter, Tinder continues to experiment with [AI-powered matching](#), which it debuted in New Zealand earlier this year. The feature delivers curated matches based on information from your Tinder profile, answers to questions, and, optionally, insights from the user's camera roll photos.

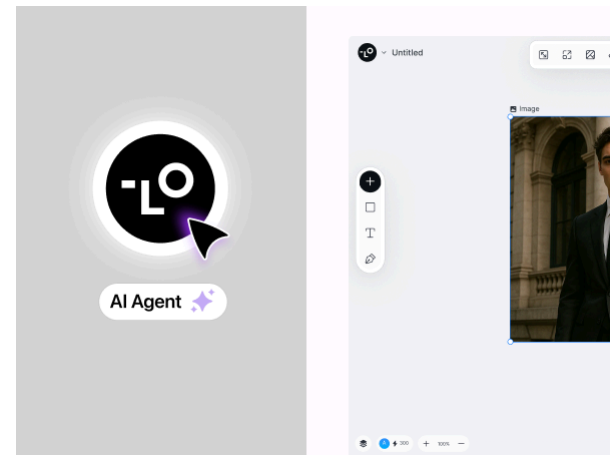
Now, the company intends to roll out this feature to more geographies.

“The interactive matching experience we’ve been testing in New Zealand is specifically designed to appeal to this type of audience [users under 30]: Somebody who doesn’t just want to be judged based on their physical appearance. [The feature is for] somebody who instead is willing to put in a little bit of time, answer some questions, and then get a custom result back,” Rascoff said.

Plus, Rascoff noted that Tinder is thinking about launching more college-specific features, including allowing users to just search within their college or other selected colleges, to appeal to younger users.

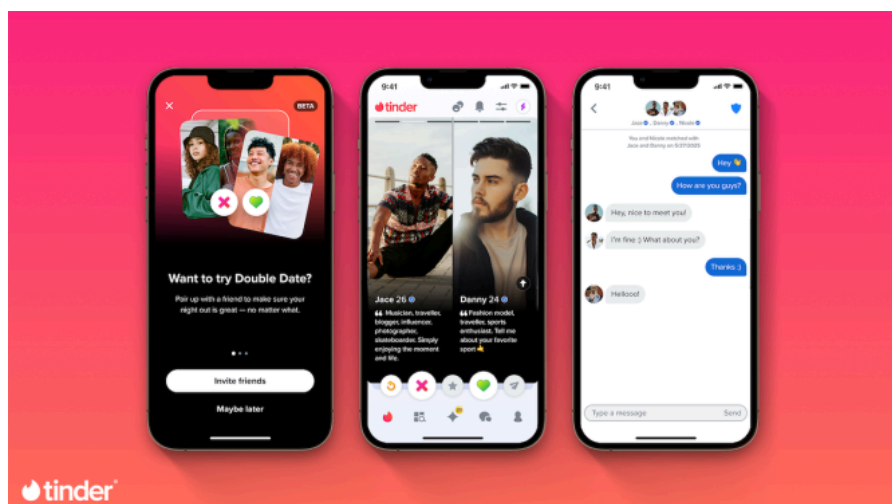
The company also offered an update on Tinder’s [Double Date option](#), launched in June, that lets users pair up with a friend to match with another couple. The dating company said it saw positive results with 92% of users utilizing the feature being under 30.

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This was Rascoff's first full quarter at the helm of Match Group, as the Zillow Group co-founder and Match board member was [appointed](#) CEO in February.

Earlier this year, the company announced that Faye Iosotaluno would step down from the app's CEO position in July, with Rascoff taking on the role. The company also laid off 13% of its staff (around 325 people) in May, and [closed open roles](#).

Topics: [Apps](#) [dating apps](#) [Match Group](#) [Social](#)

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Ivan covers global consumer tech developments at TechCrunch. He is based out of India and has previously...

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